

Objective: Be the first witch to complete Witch's Scheme cards worth 13 or more victory points.

- Gather ingredients with Familiars, cast spells on villagers and locations, and reveal completed Schemes.
- Scheme cards are worth 1, 2, or 3 points. Keep three active Schemes whenever possible.
- Core feel: worker placement, resource management, tactical movement, and interactive spell-casting.

2 SETUP CHRONOLOGY

- A** Build Wickersby: arrange all 6 location boards as a 3 x 2 rectangle, gridlines aligned.
- B** Place each Villager in the matching home: Peasant-Green, Lord-Manor, Farmer-Farm, Miller-Mill, Blacksmith-Forge, Priest-Tithe Barn.
- C** Sort four Ingredient decks beside their matching locations: Silver, Soil, Flour, and Fire.
- D** Give each witch a Book of Spells/privacy screen and one Familiar set.
- E** Deal each witch one 1-point, one 2-point, and one 3-point Scheme card.
- F** Each witch places 1 Familiar in Village Green, then players alternate placing 2 more in other locations.
- G** Draw 2 Ingredient cards for each starting Familiar at an ingredient-producing location.
- H** Give the Broom to the player whose birthday is closest to Halloween without going past.

3 STRUCTURE OF A ROUND

- 1 TITHE

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2 MOVE + CAST

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3 HARVEST

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4 PASS BROOM
- Every witch discards 1 Ingredient to the Tithe Barn, unless exempt.

In Broom order, spend up to 6 total movement; cast spells; score Schemes; refill to 3.

Draw 2 Ingredients per Familiar at an ingredient location, first come, first served.

Pass the Broom clockwise; begin the next round.



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|------------------------------|----------------------------|---------------------------|--|
| A 6 modular boards | B Villagers at home | C Ingredient decks | D Spell Books/screens |
| E 3 Scheme cards each | F 3 Familiars each | G Broom token | H Supply: frogs, rings, love tokens |

Example table arrangement. Components and location tiles may vary by setup.

TURN REMINDERS

- The 6 movement points are one shared pool across your Familiars and any Villagers you move.
- Movement is orthogonal. Spells may be cast during movement and do not consume movement points.
- Pay exactly 2 required Ingredients and speak the incantation. If caught resolving a spell without the rhyme, discard the Ingredients and the spell fails.
- Frogs cannot move alone; a Familiar in the same space must carry a frog.
- Eye of Newt is wild for spell Ingredients. Silver has a separate special use described below.

SPELL QUICK TABLE

Conjuring	Add up to 2 Familiars from your supply.
Love	Link or unlink 2 Villagers. Movement or spells affecting one affect both.
Transformation	Turn a Villager into a frog, or restore a frog.
Summoning	Move a Villager or rival Familiar to a location containing your Familiar.
Switching	Swap the locations of any 2 characters.
Binding	Lock a location: no entry, exit, or spells targeting occupants.
Unbinding	Remove Binding by paying 2 matching Ingredients of any type.
Fortune	Take any 3 Ingredients from the Tithe Barn.
Protection	Cast out of turn to cancel another witch's spell; spent Ingredients are lost.

SILVER

Discard 1 Silver to score a completed Scheme out of turn, or discard an unfinished Scheme and draw a replacement.

DURING THE GAME

- Reveal a Scheme only after every requirement is true. Other players verify it.
- Score the printed value: 1, 2, or 3 VP. Higher-value Schemes are typically harder.
- Complete any number of Schemes on your turn, then draw back to 3.
- Silver can score a completed Scheme out of turn.

END-GAME SCORING

- A witch reaching 13+ VP triggers the end of the round.
- Finish the round so all witches receive the same number of turns.
- Highest total Scheme score wins.

Tie note: The available sources do not specify a tie-breaker.

3 STRATEGIC TIPS

GOOD HABITS

- Conjure early to expand harvesting.
- Spread Familiars among useful Ingredient locations.
- Keep a Familiar in the Tithe Barn when avoiding the tithe matters.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Do not treat movement as 6 points per figure.
- Do not move frogs without a carrying Familiar.
- Do not resolve a spell silently.

COMPETITIVE TIPS

- Use Switching and Summoning for long repositioning.
- Reserve flexible Ingredients for Protection or disruption.
- Watch board positions and likely Scheme targets, not hidden hands.

RE

- Tithe is a round phase involving every witch, not just the start player.
- Harvest occurs after every witch has moved and cast spells.
- Draw 2 cards per Familiar at a producing location, subject to available cards.
- A bound location blocks movement across its boundary and protects occupants from spell targeting.
- Love causes linked Villagers to share movement and spell effects.
- Refill Scheme cards after your Move + Cast portion.
- Pass the Broom only after Harvest is complete.

5 END OF GAME

TRIGGER

- A witch reaches or exceeds 13 VP in completed Schemes.

FINISH

- Complete the current round so each witch has had an equal number of turns.

WINNER

- The witch with the highest total Scheme value is named The Village Crone.

FAST FINAL CHECK

13+ VP? Finish round. Total Schemes. Highest score wins.